Insurance Ombudsman Complaint Checklist

Bengaluru jurisdiction — what to attach, what returns a complaint, what happens next

A rejection is not the end of a claim. It is the first decision. This checklist turns a rejection letter into an Ombudsman complaint that survives the first review.

Before you file

[ ] Written repudiation or 30 days of silence from the insurer after your grievance.

[ ] Complaint filed within one year of the insurer's final decision.

[ ] The same dispute has not been filed before a consumer forum, court or arbitrator.

[ ] Amount claimed is within the Ombudsman's monetary limit of Rs. 50 lakh (raised from Rs. 30 lakh in November 2023).

Documents that decide the outcome

[ ] Policy schedule and wording — the clause the insurer relied on, highlighted.

[ ] Complete claim file: claim form, bills, discharge summary, investigation reports.

[ ] The repudiation letter, quoted word for word.

[ ] Your grievance letter and the insurer's reply, with dates and proof of delivery.

[ ] KYC and address proof; affidavit where required.

[ ] A one-page timeline of events — this is what the Ombudsman reads first.

Filing

[ ] File online through the Ombudsman portal, or by post / in person at the jurisdictional office.

[ ] Bengaluru jurisdiction covers Karnataka; the office address and email are on the IRDAI Ombudsman page — confirm before sending.

[ ] Keep the acknowledgement number and every proof of delivery.

After filing

[ ] The Ombudsman may attempt mediation; a settlement is not binding on you until accepted.

[ ] An award is binding on the insurer; you may still approach a consumer forum if the award does not settle the matter.

[ ] Track every date — the year limits are strict and are counted from the insurer's final decision, not from the claim.

Common reasons a complaint is returned

Reason	What to do
Filed before the insurer's 30 days elapsed	Wait, or attach proof the insurer closed it in writing.
Outside the one-year window	Explain the delay in the covering letter; attach dates.
Same dispute already in a consumer forum	Withdraw one, or wait for that decision.
No proof of the insurer's decision	Attach the written repudiation; never rely on a phone call.

Educational template. It is not legal advice and does not create an advisory relationship. Confirm current timelines with IRDAI, your insurer and the Insurance Ombudsman before you file. Prepared 12 November 2026.